

Lesson 10: Understanding "For and Since," "When ... ? and How Long ... ?," "Have Got and Used To"

Introduction to For and Since

"Welcome to our lesson. First, we will talk about 'for' and 'since.' These words are used to talk about time in English. 'For' is used with a period of time, like 'for two hours.' 'Since' is used with a point in time, like 'since 2010.'

In IT, we often discuss project timelines or experience duration. For example, 'I have worked here for five years' or 'I have been using this program since it was released.' How do you describe the duration of your work or use of technology?"

When ... ? and How Long ... ?

"Now, let's look at 'when ... ?' and 'how long ... ?' These are questions about time. 'When ... ?' is used to ask about a specific time, like 'When did the meeting start?' 'How long ... ?' asks about the duration, like 'How long has the server been down?'

In our IT work, we frequently need to ask about times and durations. Consider how you ask about the start time of an issue or the length of a process."

Have Got and Used To

"Finally, let's discuss 'have got' and 'used to.' 'Have got' is similar to 'have' and is often used to talk about possession, relationships, or obligations. For example, 'I have got a new laptop.' 'Used to' is about past habits or states that are no longer true, like 'I used to work in a different IT department.'

Think about how you talk about your equipment, responsibilities, or past experiences in IT. Do you use 'have got' for current situations and 'used to' for past habits?"

Dialogue between IT Professionals

"Let's see a dialogue between two IT professionals, Leah and Omar, using these expressions:

***Leah**:* Omar, how long have you been working on the network security upgrade?

***Omar**:* I've been on it for about three weeks. We started right after the last security breach, which was since early March.

***Leah**:* When did you last update the firewall settings?

***Omar**:* I updated them last Friday. But I have got to check them again; there might be new patches.

***Leah**:* I used to manage the firewall updates in my previous job. Do you need any help?

***Omar**:* That would be great. I've got a lot on my plate with this upgrade.

***Leah**:* No problem. I remember when I first started handling network security; it was overwhelming. How long has it been since you took over this role?

***Omar**:* It's been about six months now. I've learned a lot, but there's always more to learn in IT.

This conversation illustrates the use of 'for' and 'since' to talk about durations and start points, 'when ... ?' and 'how long ... ?' for specific times and durations, and 'have got' and 'used to' for current responsibilities and past experiences."

Applying 'For and Since' in IT Reporting

"When writing IT reports, how do you describe the duration of projects or problems? 'For' and 'since' are very helpful. For instance, 'The team has been working on this project for six months' or 'We have had performance issues since the last update.'

Think about your recent reports. How did you use 'for' and 'since' to describe the timeline of events or issues?"

Using 'When ... ? and How Long ... ?' in Troubleshooting

"In troubleshooting IT issues, asking the right questions is key. How do you inquire about the start or duration of a problem? You might ask, 'When did the server start malfunctioning?' or 'How long has this error been occurring?'

Consider your last troubleshooting situation. How did these questions help in diagnosing the issue?"

Describing Responsibilities and Past Roles

"In describing your current responsibilities or past roles, how do you use 'have got' and 'used to'? You might say, 'I have got to ensure the system's integrity' or 'I used to work more with hardware than software.'

Reflect on how you talk about what you currently have to do and what you used to do in your IT career. Do these expressions help in clearly differentiating your present and past experiences?"

Dialogue in Project Planning

"In project planning, communicating about durations, responsibilities, and past methods is important. Imagine a dialogue:

***Jason**: How long have you been planning the new infrastructure?*

***Nina**: We've been planning it for several months, ever since we expanded the team.*

***Jason**: When did you decide on the cloud-based solution?*

***Nina**: We decided on it last quarter. I've got to admit, I was hesitant at first.*

***Jason**: I used to be skeptical about cloud solutions too. But they've proven effective in recent projects.*

This conversation shows how Jason and Nina use 'for' and 'since' to discuss the timeline of their project, 'when ... ?' and 'how long ... ?' for specific times and durations, and 'have got' and 'used to' for current thoughts and past opinions."

Using 'For and Since' in IT Conversations

"In everyday IT conversations, how do we often talk about the duration of tasks or the starting point of projects? We use 'for' and 'since.' For example, 'I have been working on this code for two hours' or 'We have had these servers since 2018.'

Now, think about your last team meeting. How did you use 'for' and 'since' to talk about ongoing tasks or long-standing technologies? It's quite useful, isn't it, for giving a clear idea about the duration and the start of IT activities?"

The Role of 'When ... ?' and 'How Long ... ?' in IT Queries

"When asking about the timing of events or the duration of issues in IT, how do you frame your questions? We often use 'When ... ?' for specific points in time and 'How long ... ?' for durations. Like, 'When did you last update the software?' or 'How long has this bug been affecting the system?'

How often do you ask these questions in your IT role? Do you find them crucial for diagnosing issues or understanding project timelines?"

Applying 'Have Got and Used To' in Professional Context

"In a professional context, especially in IT, how do we express our current responsibilities and past experiences? 'Have got' is for present situations, as in 'I have got a meeting with the client later.' 'Used to' talks about past habits or states, like 'I used to work in software development, but now I am in network management.'

Can you remember a situation where you had to explain your current role or past experiences? How did you use 'have got' and 'used to' to make your points clear?"

Dialogue: Project Review in IT Setting

"Let's imagine a dialogue between two IT colleagues, Maya and Ethan, reviewing a project:

***Maya**:* Ethan, how long have you been working on the current software update?

***Ethan**:* I've been on it for a couple of weeks now. We started right after the client's feedback, which we received since last month.

***Maya**:* When did you encounter the integration issue?

***Ethan**:* I ran into it a few days ago. I've got to find a workaround soon.

***Maya**:* I remember when I used to handle such updates. They can be tricky.

***Ethan**:* Indeed. I had been trying different approaches for days before finding a potential solution.

***Maya**:* Have you been documenting the process?

***Ethan**:* Yes, I have. It's something I've got into the habit of doing, ever since I missed it in a past project.

This conversation illustrates the use of 'for' and 'since' to discuss durations and start points, 'when ... ?' and 'how long ... ?' for specific times and durations, and 'have got' and 'used to' for current duties and past habits."

Story from Online Teaching: Time Expressions in IT

"In my online English classes, I once had an IT professional as a student who asked, 'How do I explain the length of time I've been experiencing a software issue to our support team?' This was a practical question. I explained the use of 'for' and 'since' to describe the duration and start point of the issue. Like

saying, 'We have been facing this issue for three days' or 'This issue has been happening since the last update.'

Do you see how important it is to use these expressions correctly in IT? Accurate communication can significantly impact troubleshooting and problem-solving."

Practical Application of 'When ... ? and How Long ... ?'

"When dealing with system updates or resolving technical issues, how important is it to know the exact time or duration of events? It's crucial, right? Asking 'When did the system last undergo maintenance?' or 'How long has this error been occurring?' helps in pinpointing problems and planning actions.

In your role, how do these questions help you in your day-to-day tasks? Do they assist you in creating effective solutions?"

Using 'Have Got and Used To' in IT Roles

"In describing your current responsibilities or past roles in IT, how does the use of 'have got' and 'used to' assist in providing a clear picture? Saying 'I have got to oversee the cybersecurity of our company' defines your current obligation. In contrast, 'I used to manage the customer database' tells about a role you had in the past.

How do you use these expressions to differentiate between what you currently handle and what you were responsible for before?"

Engaging with the Audience

"Think about your last project update or technical report. How did you use 'for' and 'since,' 'when ... ?' and 'how long ... ?,' 'have got' and 'used to'? Were you able to convey the timelines, durations, current responsibilities, and past experiences effectively?

How often do you find yourself using these expressions in your professional IT communication? Do you see their importance in making your communication clear and precise?"

Continuous Improvement in Communication Skills

"In IT, continuous improvement is not just about technical skills but also about communication skills. Understanding and correctly using these expressions is part of professional growth. Reflect on your recent communications. How have you applied these English expressions to improve the clarity and effectiveness of your communication?"

Remember, the way we use language in our professional field can greatly impact our effectiveness and success."
